

QUICK GUIDE · HEALTHCARE ASSISTANCE

Pet & Veterinary Care Help

Can't afford care for a sick or injured pet? Charities and programs help with vet bills, food, and emergencies so you don't have to choose between your pet and your budget. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

If your pet has an emergency, take them to a vet first, then apply for help — many programs review applications while your pet is being treated. Apply to several at once; funds run out quickly.

1 Emergency Vet Bill Help

Charities provide grants for urgent, life-saving veterinary care.

☐ **RedRover Relief**

Financial assistance and a step-by-step grant for urgent veterinary care.

→ redrover.org/relief

☐ **Frankie's Friends**

Grants for life-saving emergency and specialty care.

→ www.frankiesfriends.org

☐ **The Pet Fund**

Help with non-urgent but necessary care like cancer treatment and heart disease.

→ www.thepetfund.com

2 Help for Low-Income Pet Owners

Programs aimed at people with limited income.

☐ **Help-A-Pet**

Vet-bill help for low-income owners (generally under \$20K single / \$40K family).

→ www.help-a-pet.com

☐ **Brown Dog Foundation**

Help for families who can't afford a one-time treatment for a pet with a good prognosis.

→ www.browndogfoundation.org

☐ **211 — Local Pet Help**

Call or search for local pet-food banks and low-cost vet programs.

→ www.211.org or dial 211

3 Low-Cost Vet Care & Spay/Neuter

Ways to get routine and preventive care affordably.

☐ **ASPCA — Low-Cost Care Finder**

Find low-cost veterinary clinics and spay/neuter services near you.

→ www.aspca.org/pet-care/general-pet-care/low-cost-spayneuter-programs

☐ **Veterinary School Clinics**

Vet teaching hospitals often provide care at reduced cost. Search your state + “veterinary school clinic.”

→ **Search your state + 'veterinary school clinic'**

4 Pet Food & Special Situations

Help keeping pets fed and cared for during hard times.

☐ **Pet Food Banks**

Many food banks and shelters offer free pet food. Ask 211 or your local animal shelter.

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☐ **Breed- & Condition-Specific Funds**

Some funds focus on certain breeds or illnesses (e.g. cancer). Search your need or ask in the Questions area.

→ **Search your breed/condition + 'fund'**

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of pet-care credit cards with high interest, and of anyone asking for fees to “release” aid. Apply to several real charities at once, and ask your vet whether they offer payment plans.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Ask your vet directly about payment plans, discounts, or a charity they work with — many keep a list. Applying to multiple programs the same day gives your pet the best chance.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need local pet help?

This guide covers national starting points. For low-cost clinics, pet-food banks, and vet help near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
